

by 3X. Men's jewellery is today the highest growth category with a CAGR of 18-20%. In fact, Men of Platinum makes up for 42% of all platinum jewellery consumed in the market today," says Banerjee.

It was in keeping with men's love for jewellery that Bvlgari launched the B.Zero 1 Kada bracelet, an India-exclusive design, in January 2024. Priced upwards of ₹12 lakh, the 18k gold bracelet is inspired by the *kada* (bracelet) that is considered sacred in the Sikh community but is also worn by a lot of men from Punjab as well as other communities. Jean Christophe Babin, CEO, Bvlgari says, "The appetite for luxury in Indians is much stronger. A decade ago, when we first came to the country there was more demand for local jewellery but now thanks to globalisation there is a lot of demand for global jewellery. We see that Indians are in the Top 3 clients in retail in many countries. We expect India to be in the Top 5 global markets for jewellery and watches."

GLOBAL BRANDS, LOCAL APPROACH

Recently, Italian luxury menswear brand Canali hosted an event celebrating its 90-year anniversary with the launch of a 'capsule collection' in Milan. While previously such a collection would have either not come to India at all or would have been made available in the country after a few months, now it was launched in India simultaneously with the rest of the world.

Canali was one of the first global brands to recognise India's importance as a luxury market and introduced its Canali jacket, inspired by the *bandhgala*, some 15 years ago. Canali has been in India for about two decades and recently opened its seventh store at Jio World Plaza (JWP) in Mumbai.

Zegna, another menswear-focussed Italian luxury brand, opened a flagship store at JWP in 2024, its second store in the city and fourth in India. In November 2023, the French luxury group Kering-owned menswear brand Brioni launched its first store in India at New Delhi's upscale Chanakya Mall, in partnership with FMCG conglomerate Dharampal Satyapal's (DS Group) DS Luxury.

Post Covid, DS Luxury, which has been a longtime partner of Tom Ford in India, began adding more foreign labels to its portfolio by establishing men's and gender-neutral stores for Berluti, Brioni, and Brunello Cucinelli in New Delhi. Ritesh Kumar, Director of DS Luxury, thanks social media for the evolution of the luxury menswear market in the past five years. "They (men) are more aware of the latest trends, and also more open to spending say, a couple of lakhs on a suit. Moreover, menswear is not as fragmented as womenswear. When it comes to global brands, the men's ready-to-wear collection does much better than womenswear. The expenditure for women is



"According to our consumer insights, 90% of men in the 31-40 age group in top metros and Tier I cities consider precious jewellery crucial for significant occasions"

VAISHALI BANERJEE

MANAGING DIRECTOR – INDIA, PLATINUM GUILD INTERNATIONAL (PGI)



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